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Stakeholder integration in sustainable business models to enhance value delivery for a broader range of stakeholders

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Abstract

Sustainable business models (SBMs) represent a contemporary approach seeking to deliver value to businesses and a wide range of stakeholders. This paper addresses the existing gap in practical guidance for businesses aiming to incorporate a wider range of stakeholders into their SBMs. To address the gap, a systematic review of academic literature and a review of mining company reports were conducted. The findings demonstrate that it is imperative to integrate stakeholders to achieve sustainability objectives, gain societal acceptance and foster legitimacy while maintaining alignment with stakeholders' concerns. To this end, the theoretical implication of this study lies in introducing a stakeholder integration model (SIM) that underscores the roles of identification, communication, knowledge sharing and continual improvement in achieving sustainability objectives and societal acceptance within SBMs. Practically, it addresses a gap by providing practical guidance for businesses to integrate stakeholders to manage risk, uncover value-creation opportunities and gain social acceptance.

KEYWORDS
corporate sustainability, stakeholder engagement, stakeholder integration, stakeholder theory, sustainable business models, sustainable value proposition, systematic literature review

1 | INTRODUCTION

The global goal of reaching sustainable development (SD) has propelled businesses to seek ways to contribute toward this objective. SD is a development that meets the needs of present generations without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs (WCED, 1987). To achieve SD, multiple stakeholders, including businesses, have the responsibility to work toward achieving sustainable development goals (SDGs). In this light, businesses ought to incorporate best practices aimed at social well-being and environmental awareness in their strategic planning and business operations (Fiorentino et al., 2020; Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017). This may be achieved by integrating a corporate sustainability approach into the business strategy (Witjes & Lozano, 2016).

Corporate sustainability involves businesses' ongoing commitment to adapt and innovate their business models (BMs) toward sustainability, including enhancing their methods of engaging with stakeholders to address SD issues (Schaltegger et al., 2016; Witjes & Lozano, 2016). BM is a designed set of techniques and processes that businesses follow to determine their value offering and to whom this value is aimed, including actors involved in creating said value (Andreassen et al., 2018). The necessity to innovate toward SBM has encouraged the growth of research on sustainable business models

Abbreviations: (S)BM, sustainable business models; ICMM, International Council on Mining and Metals; SD(G), sustainable development goals; SIM, stakeholder integration model; SLO, social license to operate.

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(SBMs) (Attanasio et al., 2022). SBMs are widely described as mechanisms or steps by which businesses create and exchange mutual value with their stakeholders (Baldassarre et al., 2017; Bocken et al., 2014). Value creation denotes the strategy employed by businesses to turn resources into beneficial outputs to meet stakeholders' needs (Baldassarre et al., 2017).

SBMs enable businesses to fulfil their corporate social responsibilities and corporate sustainability objectives and create value for a broader range of stakeholders by balancing environmental, social and economic aspects, also referred to as the triple bottom line (Boons & Lüdeke-Freund, 2013). To create said value, SBMs take a systematic approach and holistically factor in different stakeholders' interests material to the focal business ecosystem (Bocken et al., 2014). The normative view of BM is centred around maximum value creation for all stakeholders involved (Zott & Amit, 2010), and stakeholder theory solidifies this normative perspective in SBMs by asserting that the overarching goal of business is to produce and sustain value for both primary (those who determine the success of the business) and secondary (those who may affect or be affected by the business) stakeholders (Freeman et al., 2007). This demonstrates the need for businesses to engage with their stakeholders and include their interests in the overall business bottom line. Hence, this study focuses on stakeholder integration in SBMs.

Stakeholder engagement developed from stakeholder management and is founded on stakeholder theory. It is seen as a method to implement stakeholder management that goes beyond simply handling stakeholders to reduce organisational risks (Kujala et al., 2022). Engaging with stakeholders, both primary and secondary stakeholders, to integrate them into SBMs has been recognised as advantageous. The reason is that secondary stakeholders have the capacity to shape the perspectives of primary stakeholders, thereby functioning as a form of risk mitigation (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016; Kujala et al., 2012). Additionally, the benefits extend to enhancing shared value creation (Velter et al., 2020), making contributions to societal well-being (Ordonez-Ponce et al., 2021), and mitigating environmental impact (Basile et al., 2021).

Literature on SBM has shown a gap in knowledge on stakeholder engagement (Bocken et al., 2014, 2019; Preghenella & Battistella, 2021; Schneider & Clauss, 2020). To fill this knowledge gap, scholars (Attanasio et al., 2022; Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021a; 2021b) have explored stakeholder interactions and roles in SBMs. Others have highlighted the significance of integrating stakeholders at different stages of sustainability, considering factors like the type of stakeholder integrated and the extent of their engagement (Juntunen et al., 2019). Moreover, studies have revealed that stakeholder engagement enhances organisational performance in higher educational institutions' sustainability efforts (Giovanelli et al., 2021) and also in the context of product development (Juntunen et al., 2019). In terms of the characteristics needed to integrate stakeholders in SBM, Matos and Silvestre (2013) and Morioka et al. (2017) have emphasised the importance of learning and capability building in organisations for proactively addressing stakeholders' interests and concerns.

Furthermore, SBM literature highlights a need for businesses to bridge a knowledge gap by effectively engaging a variety of stakeholders, stressing the importance of enhancing stakeholder integration to identify opportunities for value creation and fostering a conducive organisational culture to achieve sustainability goals (Stubbs, 2017). Although various scholars (Attanasio et al., 2022; Fiore et al., 2020; Freudenreich et al., 2019; Tapaninaho & Heikkinen, 2022) have pointed to the importance of integrating stakeholders in SBM, there is an inadequate amount of literature that practically tackles stakeholder integration in SBM. Thus, this study contributes by exploring the process that businesses can follow to ensure effective stakeholder integration in SBMs.

Businesses whose operations specifically affect a wide range of stakeholders, such as mining businesses, could benefit from the effective integration of stakeholders into their business operations. In particular, the need to incorporate stakeholders in BMs for sustainability in mining could be beneficial, as the industry has historically been accused of infringing on both the environmental rights and social well-being of those in close proximity (Haddaway et al., 2019). In addition, mining companies run the financial risk associated with the push-back of mining operations by material stakeholders such as local communities (Dunbar et al., 2020). To minimise the risk associated with stakeholder dissatisfaction, it is then important to come up with recommendations for organisations that affect a wide range of stakeholders on how to integrate stakeholders in their value-creation processes (Drusche & Krause, 2021).

There is a consensus that BM innovation geared toward sustainability needs to incorporate the interests of a wide range of stakeholders in different kinds of businesses—including mining businesses—to combat the added social and environmental risks that are endured (Comin et al., 2020; Drusche & Krause, 2021; Dunbar et al., 2020). Understanding the interests of the respective stakeholders could also open a channel for mining businesses to uncover potential value co-creation opportunities (Kurek et al., 2023) and increase their chances of securing a social licence to operate (SLO) (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016; Comin et al., 2020; Poelzer & Yu, 2021).

Various literature points to the challenges of successfully executing stakeholder integration due to stakeholders differing interests and other resource inconveniences tied to this process (Evans et al., 2017; Matos & Silvestre, 2013). However, this study would like to bring an alternative view to the discussion on stakeholder integration in SBM and provide practical guidance to aid in the process of stakeholder integration based on insight gathered from existing literature. Despite the absence of a standard procedure available to aid companies in stakeholder integration in SBM, current academic literature (Breuer et al., 2018; Freudenreich et al., 2019; Guo et al., 2022; Tapaninaho & Heikkinen, 2022) has provided pockets of information, and industry actors have also formulated guiding principles that can be used to facilitate the process of stakeholder engagement (GRI, 2015; ICMM, 2023; IRMA, 2018).

It is worth noting that stakeholder integration in this study refers to the inclusion of stakeholders into the businesses' decision-making

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processes, operations and overall BM, including the communication channels. While both stakeholder interaction (communication) and stakeholder integration (inclusion in decision-making) can be seen as components of stakeholder engagement, in this study, we focus on integration as it is meant to align the business goals and actions with the expectations and interests of its stakeholders, promoting a sense of shared ownership, responsibility and broad value creation.

Thus, the purpose of this study is to extend the SBM literature by exploring how stakeholder integration can be used to deliver value to a broad range of stakeholders in SBM. The study is intended to answer the following research questions:

RQ1: What constitutes an SBM?
RQ2: What is the relevance of stakeholder management in SBM?
RQ3: Which steps can businesses take to effectively integrate a wide range of stakeholders in their SBM?

Through a systematic literature review and analysis of industry documentation, the study aims to develop a process of stakeholder integration in SBM. This study is structured in the following order. The next chapter will tackle the research method used in this study, followed by a chapter on the analysis of the findings obtained from the sampled literature. Thereafter, a proposed stakeholder integration model (SIM) will be presented and tested using secondary data from the mining industry, and finally, the concluding remarks and future recommendations will be outlined.

2 | RESEARCH METHODS

2.1 | Research design

The study was designed to comprehensively explore the literature on SBM and its link to mutual value creation for a diverse range of stakeholders. To achieve this, a qualitative research method was employed. Specifically, a systematic literature review methodology was combined with an analysis of secondary data (corporate reports, e.g., sustainability reports) to ensure a comprehensive assessment of the existing body of knowledge of stakeholder management in SBMs. This approach facilitated the analysis of extant literature and the development of recommendations to address identified gaps. The adoption of this methodological approach enhanced the study's credibility through validation (Hammarberg et al., 2016; Ridder, 2017).

2.2 | Data collection

A systematic literature review was chosen as the preferred methodological approach to ensure methodological rigour, reduce bias and minimise fragmentation, which were critical considerations for this study (Tranfield et al., 2003). Systematic literature reviews are well-established in sustainability-related research for their ability to provide a transparent reflection of the state of knowledge and to support the formulation of informed conclusions (Cillo et al., 2019; Comin et al., 2020; Dijkstra et al., 2020; Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021). To identify relevant literature, a set of keywords and search strings documented in Table 1 was utilised. Web of Science and Scopus were selected as the primary databases based on their widespread use in prior research, their reputation and their comprehensive coverage (Cillo et al., 2019; Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021b; Preghenella & Battistella, 2021). These databases are globally recognised as the leading bibliographic resources (Singh et al., 2021; Zhu & Liu, 2020). The search spanned the years 2000–2022, guided by the observable growth in literature on SBMs, as evidenced by recent bibliographic and systematic literature reviews (Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021; Preghenella & Battistella, 2021). The selected literature types consisted of peer-reviewed journal articles, chosen for their inherent credibility resulting from rigorous evaluation by scholars.

TABLE 1 Keywords and search strings.

Keyword	Search strings
Industry	(firm* OR compan* OR corporat* OR business* OR organisation* OR industry*OR organization*)
Sustainability	(sustainab* OR "corporate social responsibility" OR csr OR "corporate sustainability" OR cs OR "corporate responsibility" OR cr)
Business models	("business model*" OR "sustainab* business model*" OR " business model* for sustainab*" OR " value flow" OR "value creat*" OR "creay* value" OR "value capt*" OR "capt* value" OR "value propos*" OR "propos* value" OR "value deliver*" OR "deliver* value" OR "co-creat*" OR "value co-creat*" OR "value destroy*" OR "value mapping" OR "destroy* value")
Stakeholder engagement	(stakeholder*) AND (role* OR interact* OR collaborat* OR engag* OR involv* OR partnership* OR relationship* OR cooperat* OR participat*)

A total of 1070 articles were identified in the Web of Science search, and 664 articles were retrieved from Scopus. Preliminary relevance assessment involved reviewing the titles and abstracts of these articles. Duplicates were eliminated, and the remaining articles underwent further scrutiny through a process of skimming and scanning their content. The exclusion criteria encompassed non-English papers, conference papers, books and proceedings. Sustainability in businesses is of widespread interest and has been approached from various angles, such as the adoption of technology as an enabler for SBM (Fiorentino et al., 2020) and the developments in SBM as a research field (Lüdeke-Freund & Dembek, 2017). To maintain a concentrated view of the relevance of engaging stakeholders in SBM, literature that did not emphasise this aspect was excluded from the primary sample. The selection process can be found in Figure 1.

Literature encountered through a snowballing approach, including the works of Bini et al. (2018), Cubilla-Montilla et al. (2019), Martin and Phillips, 2021 and Juntunen et al. (2019), were not added to the primary sample. Nevertheless, these sources were used to enrich the

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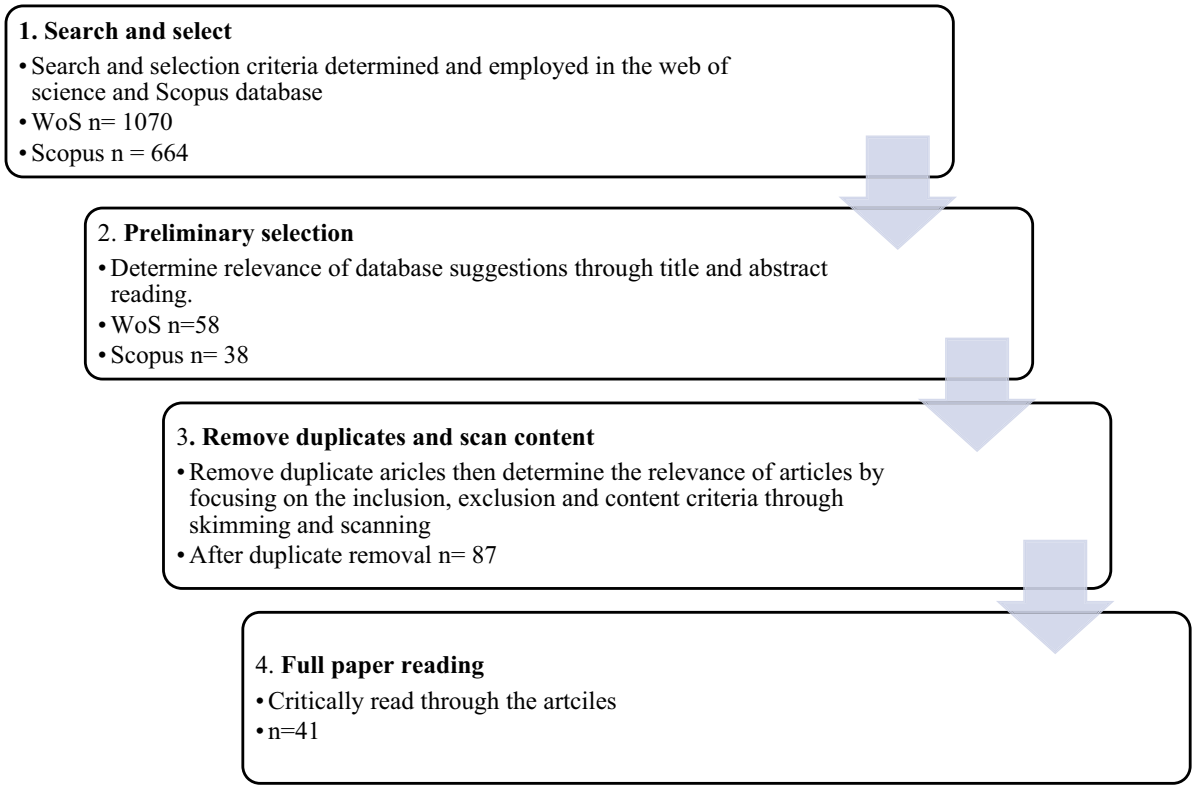


FIGURE 1 Systematic literature selection process and the number of articles after each step.

study's overall contributions. The inclusion criteria comprised English-language peer-reviewed articles published from January 2000 to December 2022 and articles addressing the implementation of SBM; preference was given to articles discussing aspects of stakeholder management. After applying the exclusion and inclusion criteria, a total of 41 articles were selected as the primary sources for this study and were subject to detailed examination.

2.3 | Case selection

To address the practical contribution of this study, company reports were considered valuable sources of real-world practices and data that might not be readily available in academic literature. Thus, to gain information-rich insights into stakeholder engagement in SBM, purposeful sampling was employed to select cases that could provide substantial insights (Patton, 2002). The sample encompassed company reports from 25 mining and metals companies; see Table 2. Eisenhardt and Graebner (2007) assert that consulting multiple cases facilitates the generalisation of the study findings.

The selection criteria for these companies were based on their common membership in the International Council on Mining and Metals (ICMM) and their commitment to sustainable business practices. Although these companies were headquartered in different countries, they were all multi-corporations dedicated to sustainable business operations and adherence to the 10 ICMM principles, which encompass stakeholder engagement. The list of companies was sourced from the official ICMM website as of 21 September 2023, and their corporate reports were collected from the respective company websites. The analysis of these reports was guided by the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) standard for stakeholder engagement disclosure and the ICMM guiding principles on stakeholder engagement.

2.4 | Data analysis

The study aimed to propose a process for stakeholder integration in SBM for broad value creation. The use of a qualitative method for this aim is fitting, as it serves as a means to make sense of the concept of stakeholder integration in SBM (Alvesson & Sandberg, 2011). Thus, the selected articles were categorised into three themes. The first theme analysed the definition of SBMs to address RQ1, and the second theme analysed the stakeholders' contribution to value creation in SBMs addressing RQ2. The codes for this theme included information on how stakeholders contribute to creating economic (e.g., profitability or cost savings), social (e.g., community development) and environmental value (e.g., environmental performance such as reduced emissions).

The third theme addressing RQ3 focused on stakeholder engagement strategies in SBM, and to code for this theme, the literature was analysed for information such as communication channels, feedback mechanisms and collaboration initiatives between the business and stakeholders. To facilitate literature synthesis, an Excel sheet was used to organise the articles, including their thematic content,

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TABLE 2 List of mining companies and reports.

Company name	Report name (date)
African Rainbow Minerals	Integrated annual report (2022)
Alcoa	Annual report (2022)
Anglo American	Integrated report (2022)
AngloGold Ashanti	Integrated report (2022)
Antofagasta Minerals	Annual report (2022)
Barrick	Sustainability report (2022)
BHP	Annual report (2023)
Boliden	Annual and sustainability report (2022)
Codelco	Comprehensive report (2022)
Freepor-t-McMoran	Annual report on sustainability (2022)
Glencore	Sustainability report (2022)
Gold Fields Limited	Integrated annual report (2022)
Hydro	Annual report (2022)
Minera San Cristòbal	Sustainability report (2022)
MMG limited	Sustainability report (2022)
Newcrest Mining Limited	Sustainability report (2023)
Newmont	Sustainability report (2022)
Orano	Annual activity report (2021)
RioTinto	Annual report (2022)
Sibanye Stilwater	Integrated report (2022)
South32	Sustainable development report (2023)
Sumitomo Metal Mining	Integrated report (2022)
Teck	Sustainability report (2022)
Vale	Integrated report (2022)

typology, methodology, key arguments, future research recommendations and context.

Data on the SBMs of the companies were obtained from corporate reports through a structured coding process that focused on the dimensions of social, environmental and economic aspects. Furthermore, a coding procedure was employed to evaluate the incorporation of stakeholder engagement within the BM. This involved an analysis of data related to the overarching strategies of stakeholder engagement, the extent of stakeholder participation in decision-making processes, stakeholder consultation, comprising data regarding communication with stakeholders, and stakeholder engagement success or failures communicated. The subsequent section outlines the findings derived from the analysis.

3 | FINDINGS

This section presents the findings from the literature review, following Tranfield et al.'s (2003) recommendation for systematic review, which involves categorising content to provide detailed information about the literature, presenting the current knowledge state from the data and offering the researcher's conclusions. The findings section begins with descriptive findings, covering article age, publication sources, research methods, typology and research context. It proceeds with content analysis, proposing an SIM, and assessing its alignment with current industry stakeholder engagement processes for sustainable businesses. In the following section, the findings are discussed and conclusions are drawn.

The methodology yielded a result of 41 articles addressing SBM in different contexts. The findings illustrate that SBM was explored in varying environments, and this signifies that the need to innovate toward more sustainable practices is interesting for different industries (Acciarini et al., 2022; Baldassarre et al., 2017; Fiore et al., 2020; Fiorentino et al., 2020; Giovanelli et al., 2021; Mihailova et al., 2022; Press et al., 2020). The full list of industries, along with the years of publication for the respective articles, can be found in Appendix A.

The age profile of the sampled articles is depicted in Figure 2. More articles targeting SBM with a stakeholder perspective were prevalent in the literature between 2019 and 2022; this depicts that although in its infancy, stakeholder management in SBM literature is growing. Most of the articles sampled in this study were published in the Journal of Cleaner Production (15) and Business Strategy and the Environment (6), with the rest of the articles spread across an array of journals as depicted in Figure 3. The typology of the sampled articles included empirical, literature reviews, conceptual, theoretical and mixed methods. The increased amount of empirical research can be attributed to the infancy of the SBMfield. This calls for researchers to delve into the details of the subject to understand the concepts dynamics and contribute toward theoretical development in the field (Guo et al., 2022; Matos & Silvestre, 2013).

3.1 | Sustainable business models

This section outlines what the sampled literature discusses in response to RQ1. The literature refers to SBM in various ways, for example, BMs for sustainability, sustainability-oriented BMs or circular economy businesses for sustainability (Attanasio et al., 2022; Breuer et al., 2018; Tapaninaho & Heikkinen, 2022). Despite the varying terminology, the essence of the definitions lies in the objective of the concepts. The goal is to achieve a balance between minimising environmental harm, sustaining social well-being and simultaneously supporting financial growth to maintain business operations (Attanasio et al., 2022; Bocken et al., 2014; Breuer et al., 2018; Stubbs & Cocklin, 2008; Tapaninaho & Heikkinen, 2022).

A study by Upward and Jones (2016) described SBM implementation as a continuum. The authors explain weak and strong sustainability and how this shapes the attainment of a successful sustainable business. Strong sustainability includes a selection of human and non-human stakeholders and caters to the interests of the respective stakeholders (Dijkstra et al., 2020; Upward & Jones, 2016). Velter et al. (2020) also lean toward the definition of SBM as 'BM that incorporates pro-active multi-stakeholder management'. Another set of researchers has also defined SBM in terms of the resources needed for its successful implementation, such as technological innovations (Bocken et al., 2014; Dentchev et al., 2018; Fiorentino et al., 2020). It

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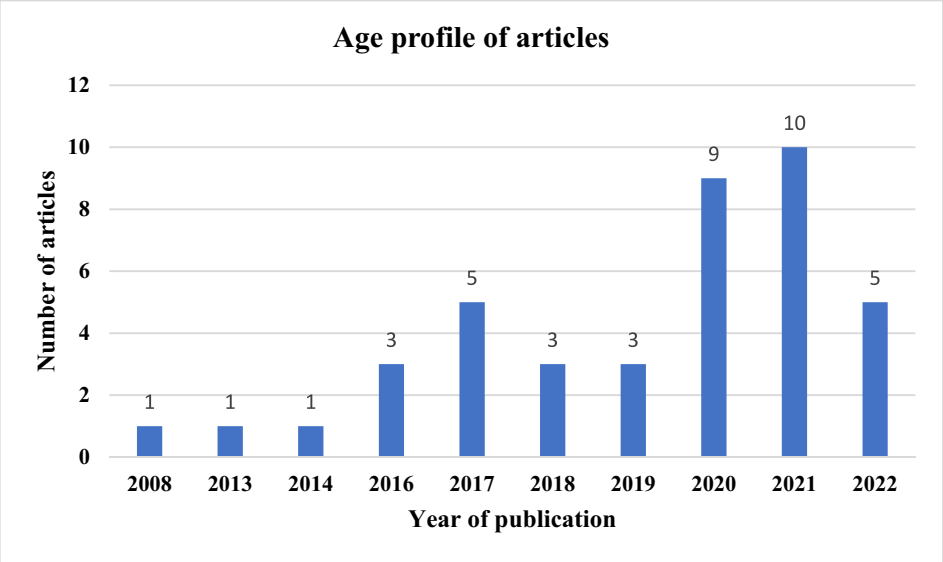


FIGURE 2 The number of relevant sustainable business model (SBM) articles against their year of publication.

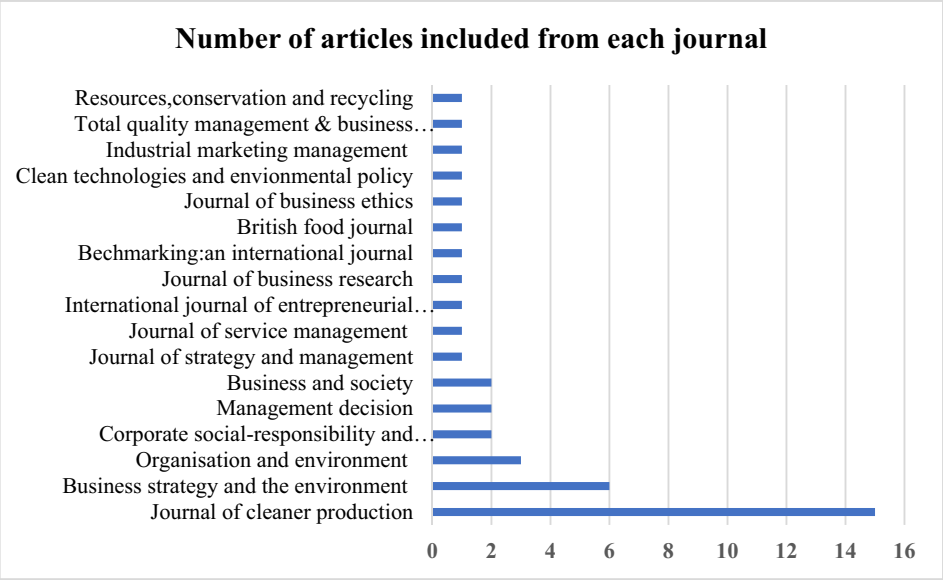


FIGURE 3 The number of articles included from each journal.

is worth noting that even with technology seen as a defining resource for SBM implementation, scholars who have explored the benefits of leveraging technology in SBM allude to the need for stakeholder interaction (Goni et al., 2021; Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017) to close information gaps and ensure the adoption of technology as an aiding tool in SBM.

3.2 | Stakeholder value creation in SBM

3.2.1 | Economic dimension

The relevance of stakeholders in SBM is divided into the three dimensions of sustainability and responds to RQ2. The integration of stakeholders in SBM is important as businesses evolve from merely producing financial value for primary stakeholders to aiming to create value for and with a broader range of stakeholders (Stubbs & Cocklin, 2008; Upward & Jones, 2016), to contribute to SD (Morioka et al., 2017) and to ensure the sustainability of the business in the long term (Stubbs, 2017). The inclusion of a wide range of stakeholders has been demonstrated to bring both financial and non-financial value to businesses and their stakeholders (Fiore et al., 2020). Guo et al. (2022) found that prioritising non-financial stakeholder interests, like eco-friendly treatment processes, can boost financial value in the sewage waste industry.

Ordonez-Ponce et al. (2021) and Bittencourt Marconatto et al. (2016) assert that profit maximisation should not be the sole motivating factor to include stakeholders, as other factors such as attaining social acceptance are just as crucial for the survival of the business. Related to this view, Dijkstra et al. (2020) state that businesses that tend to focus on financial maximisation seem to implement weak sustainability initiatives. It then brings the view that, while the inclusion

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of stakeholders in SBM may bring financial value to the organisation, this should not be the main driver if the goal is to create broad value. Other drivers for broad value creation may be propelling factors such as regulatory requirements and stakeholder pressure (i.e., push factors) (Fiorentino et al., 2020) or incentivising factors such as financial opportunities (i.e., pull factors) (Dijkstra et al., 2020).

3.2.2 | Social dimension

Stakeholders additionally contribute to value creation in SBM through social acceptance of the business. Biloslavo et al. (2020) assert that legitimacy, whether pragmatic or morally motivated, requires external stakeholder support to attain social legitimation, such as reputation. Bittencourt Marconatto et al. (2016) have taken the discussion further and demonstrated that external stakeholders, such as local communities possess resources, expertise and native capabilities that could bring value to the focal business. Ordonez-Ponce et al. (2021) extend this resource-based view on stakeholder engagement and encourage stakeholder partnerships as a mechanism to integrate stakeholders in decision-making processes that shape the wider sustainability goals of the business. Partnerships between businesses and stakeholders when both parties have and work toward a joint sustainability purpose may bring social, economic and environmental value (Reinhardt et al., 2020). For maximum value creation in the social dimension of sustainability, businesses ought to understand the interests and concerns of stakeholders (Comin et al., 2020) to appropriately innovate their BM and create value that resonates with its stakeholders (Freudenreich et al., 2019); this includes engaging and collaborating (Bocken et al., 2014; Witjes & Lozano, 2016) with external stakeholders to create joint value (Tapaninaho & Heikkinen, 2022).

3.2.3 | Environmental dimension

Environmental performance, such as the reduction of emissions, has been used as a determinant of a business's sustainability, particularly in circular BMs (Reinhardt et al., 2020). Basile et al. (2021), however, bring into conversation that a focus on environmental aspects may also bring economic sustainability, but for successful implementation, there should be communication between the business and its stakeholder groups. Recent literature also proposes that the environment is seen as a key stakeholder as it plays a role in business's success (Bocken et al., 2014; Chirumalla et al., 2022). Scholars have noted that suppliers and other stakeholders can impact a business's reputation through how they manage factors like working conditions, local community effects and environmental impact (Norris et al., 2021). This highlights the importance for businesses to consider the broader influence of their entire value chain on various stakeholders, including their environmental impact. Stakeholders have also been seen as playing a role in influencing environmental value creation and BM innovations toward sustainability (Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021b) by changing consumption patterns (Acciarini et al., 2022).

3.3 | Stakeholder engagement strategies

To address RQ3, the literature emphasised the need for understanding different stakeholders' interests (Guo et al., 2022), values and needs (Freudenreich et al., 2019), while also managing expectations (Freeman et al., 2007; Harrison & Wicks, 2019) and communication (Goni et al., 2021). Understanding the values of the stakeholders will guide the business in identifying aspects that are material to the success of the business, assist in formulating a value proposition (Baldassarre et al., 2017) and minimise the implications of strained relationships between the stakeholder network (Mihailova et al., 2022) and the business that may lead to issues of denied legitimacy. The literature asserts that awareness of the focal firm to its stakeholder network determines its ability to employ the right kind of strategies to attain its sustainability mission while minimising potential risk (Norris et al., 2021; Press et al., 2020; Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017).

The strategic steps for successful stakeholder integration mentioned in the literature included constant negotiation and dialogue (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016; S. Pedersen et al., 2023) and knowledge exchange (Chirumalla et al., 2022) between the business and stakeholder groups for successful BM innovation. To this end, Goni et al. (2021) touch on four principles (i.e., partnership, participation, communication and consultation) that should be considered to integrate stakeholders in SBM. Guo et al. (2022) further this view and postulate the need to identify and leverage dynamic capabilities (i.e., sensing, learning, integrating and coordinating) to achieve higher innovation performance and encourage innovative ways to integrate stakeholders in the value-creation process. To achieve successful SBM implementation, businesses are also advised to leverage their native capabilities, that is, expertise that allows companies to solicit resources that are unique to the community in which they operate.

Integrating different stakeholder groups through collaborative efforts during the value creation stage has enhanced SBM implementation (Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017) and assisted in overcoming challenges associated with SBM innovation (Baldassarre et al., 2017). The inclusion of a wide stakeholder group earlier on during BM innovation can be beneficial to assessing possible value destruction within the network (Andreassen et al., 2018). To achieve the level of collaboration needed for successful integration of stakeholders, Schneider and Clauss (2020) bring into the discussion that managers influence this decision based on beliefs and how they prioritise sustainability and thus recommend capacity building for stakeholders through pre-defined guidelines on how to best integrate stakeholders. Matos and Silvestre (2013) and Morioka et al. (2017) assert that capacity building in the form of training and implementation of management systems can aid the value delivery process. Limited education and geographical disparities may hinder successful collaboration and value co-creation opportunities. It may even, in some instances, become a hindrance to successful SBM implementation through denied social acceptance (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016).

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On the other hand, critiques about the practicality of including and understanding the values of an increased number of stakeholders have surfaced, with others pointing to the inconvenience of the exercise to the focal company (Biloslavo et al., 2020) or the regulatory restrictions, lack of knowledge and ambiguous stakeholder roles in the value creation process (Chirumalla et al., 2022). The stakeholder view in SBM does not undermine the complexity of including a wide range of stakeholders in the existing systems but aims to encourage an alternative manner of business that considers societal welfare and environmental well-being for more sustainable business operations. Thus, based on the revelations of existing literature, this study aims to give guidance on the steps to follow for stakeholder integration in SBM.

3.4 | Stakeholder integration model

Developing an SIM is important for businesses to ensure that they are considering the perspectives and interests of all stakeholders in their decision-making processes. Stakeholders can have a significant impact on a business's operations and success, and their opinions and concerns should be considered. With the developed SIM, businesses can better understand the interests of their stakeholders and work toward building stronger relationships with them. This can lead to improved decision-making, increased stakeholder satisfaction, and ultimately, greater long-term value creation for the business. It also enables businesses to identify potential risks and opportunities, such as emerging market trends or changing consumer preferences, and respond to them on time.

The SIM explores stakeholder management in SBM to get an image of which organisational processes may create a conducive environment for stakeholder interaction. The SIM tackles the need for an adaptable process for stakeholder integration by consolidating different vital considerations in successful SBM implementation, such as the identification of stakeholders, communication between stakeholders and the business and the establishment of a joint purpose, just to mention a few. The adoption of such a model can give businesses

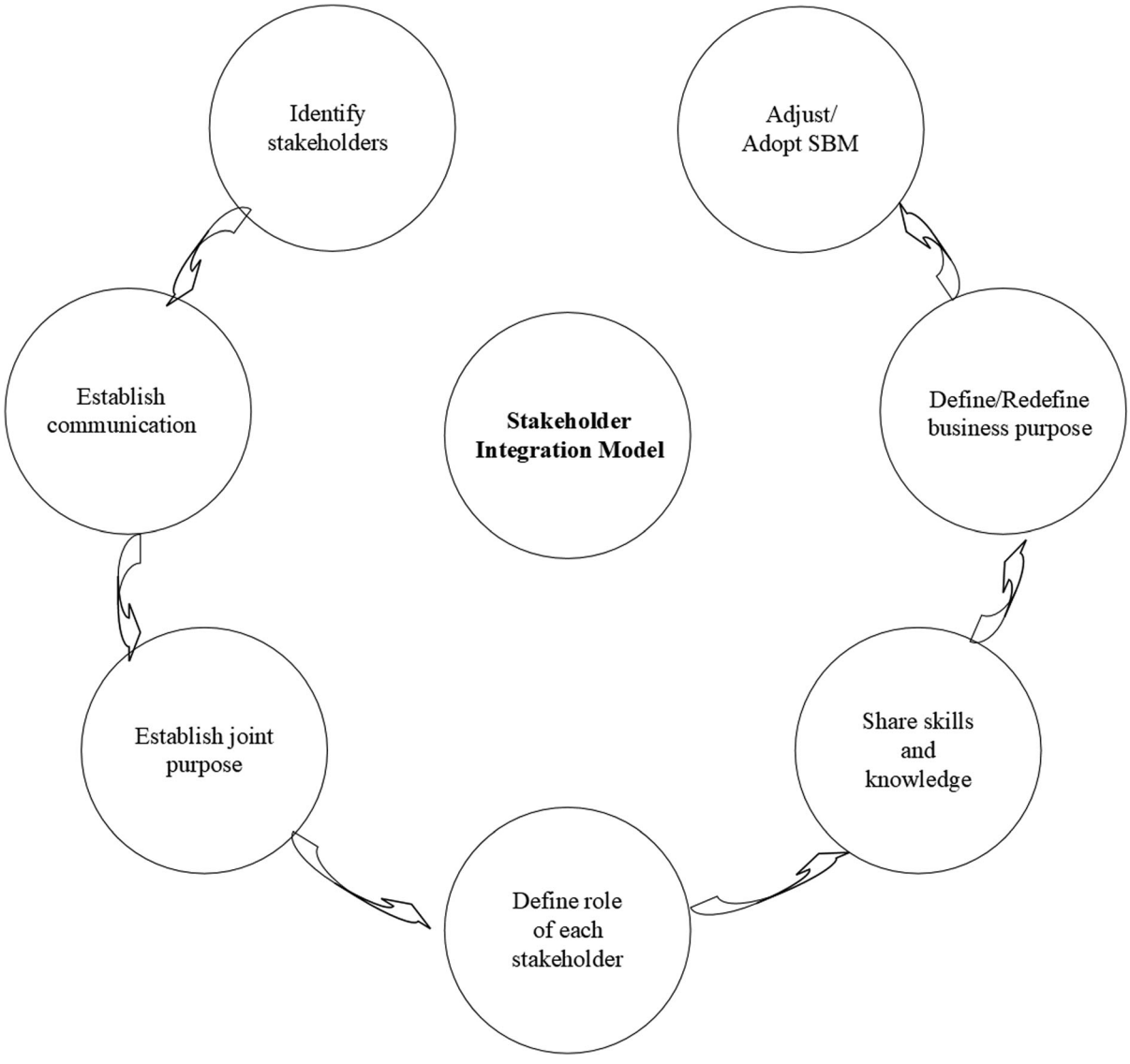


FIGURE 4 Stakeholder integration model. *Source*: Author's illustration.

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an edge in minimising the risk associated with stakeholder dissatisfaction and contribute toward the attainment of a social licence and competitive advantage.

Following contributions from the assessed literature, an SIM is suggested to narrow the gap in the literature, providing intuitive steps for stakeholder integration as businesses transition to or implement SBM. As informed by the literature, the SIM is designed as a 7-step iterative process to guide stakeholder integration for successful SBM implementation (Figure 4).

3.4.1 | Identify stakeholders

The integration of a broad range of stakeholders in SBMs requires the identification of the stakeholders that may be affected by or that may affect the business operations (Freeman et al., 2007). SBM requires the inclusion of both primary and secondary stakeholders. Bocken et al. (2014) solidify this view by stating that 'a sustainable business model aligns interests of all stakeholder groups, and explicitly considers the environment and society as key stakeholders' (p. 44). The identification of stakeholders positions the focal company in a position to forecast any possible impacts the stakeholders might have on the success of the business and its effect on the stakeholders (Freeman et al., 2007); identification and communication with the identified stakeholders afford the focal company a good-standing reputation, trust and overall social acceptance for its operations (Ranängen & Lindman, 2020).

The identification of stakeholders can be done by categorising stakeholders as primary stakeholders (e.g., suppliers) and secondary stakeholders (e.g., special interest groups) (Freeman et al., 2007). Following the identification of the stakeholders that fit in each category, the analysis of the different stakeholder interests, needs and expectations can be done with tools such as the value mapping tool (Bocken et al., 2013) and the stakeholder value creation framework (Freudenreich et al., 2019) to assess the stakeholders level of influence and interest in the business operations. This exercise will assist businesses in determining the appropriate level of engagement with each stakeholder group. For deeper insight into the values and interests of the stakeholders, mutual communication channels need to be established.

3.4.2 | Establish communication/maintain mutual communication

Transparent mutual communication forms an important step in integrating stakeholders in SBM (Stubbs, 2017) and for overall successful SBM implementation (Basile et al., 2021). Chirumalla et al. (2022) talk about communication between stakeholders to understand the sustainability vision of the focal business and for stakeholders to identify where they fit (roles) in realising the BM. Continuous communication will ensure that all stakeholder groups are informed and that they feel included and valued, which will result in them advocating for the business and reducing issues of mistrust and low participation that may hinder successful SBM implementation (Mihailova et al., 2022). During mutual communication, focal businesses will benefit from being mindful of differing value tensions that may arise between the stakeholder groups (S. Pedersen et al., 2023). The quality of communication fostered by the focal company will inform the quality of the relationship between itself and its stakeholders. The aim of the communication should be to establish an inter-organisational view, to understand the differing interests amongst the stakeholders and to look at how different business scenarios can affect the entire business ecosystem (Morioka et al., 2017; Norris et al., 2021; S. Pedersen et al., 2023). Businesses can adopt mutual communication frameworks to clearly and openly communicate with their stakeholders to determine their joint purpose.

3.4.3 | Establish a joint purpose

The trust that will be cultivated through open and continuous communication will be the foundation for establishing a joint purpose. The focal business can invest in sound SE processes to balance the interests of stakeholders. This step in the integration process will enable the appropriate selection of governance models that integrate sustainability issues in value-creation processes so that the results benefit all stakeholders (Evans et al., 2017).

Engaging stakeholders to establish a joint purpose and align stakeholder interests while integrating ethical issues is paramount for successful SBM implementation. Freudenreich et al. (2019) state that an understanding of what is valuable for the stakeholders and organisation should be clear, and each of the parties should realise the contributions of the respective stakeholder in creating and delivering the value. Furthermore, the process of establishing a joint purpose should be about identifying the values, cultural norms and interests of the different stakeholders and managing the value tensions that may arise in the network (Breuer et al., 2018; E. R. G. Pedersen et al., 2021).

Defining a joint purpose also entails uncovering collaboration opportunities and applying the right coordination strategies to ensure the seamless flow of value toward all stakeholders in the form of efficient resource use, customer awareness (Dijkstra et al., 2020), the development and use of new technology to enrich SBM (Fiorentino et al., 2020) and enhancing reputation and trust amongst the stakeholder network (Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017).

3.4.4 | Define stakeholder roles

Contribution by all stakeholder groups is necessary for achieving an SBM. The contribution can be through financial investments or through granting legitimacy and championing company operations. The different forms of contributions will assist businesses in yielding both monetary (e.g., financial growth and scaling) and non-monetary (e.g., work-life balance) value, affording cascaded value (e.g., better work conditions to workers of the focal companies' suppliers) even to

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indirect stakeholders in their value network (Morioka et al., 2017). Bocken et al. (2014) state that ' value is no longer created by firms acting autonomously, but by firms acting together with parties external to the firm through informal arrangements or formal alliances' (p. 43). These collaborations require that the roles of the stakeholders be defined. These roles can be those of environmental stewardship (Bocken et al., 2014) or of granting social acceptance (Biloslavo et al., 2020; Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016).

The ambiguity of the roles of stakeholders has been seen as a barrier to successful SBM implementation (Chirumalla et al., 2022); as such, businesses must commit resources to define each stakeholder's roles, as this would determine the success rate of implementing the SBM (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016). Defining stakeholder roles assists in bringing clarity about what each stakeholder expects, fosters collaboration between the different stakeholder groups, improves accountability and enhances transparency. Velter et al. (2020) also highlight the fluidity needed in role-taking for SBM. The flexibility required to assume different roles in SBM requires certain skills and competencies.

3.4.5 | Equip stakeholders with skills

Stakeholders must be equipped with the knowledge to undertake their respective roles and contribute toward SBM implementation. Velter et al. (2020) refer to these 'competence boundaries', skills and knowledge needed to ensure stakeholder and organisational alignment. Relevant upskilling and competence-building should be provided to the respective stakeholders (Morioka et al., 2017).

Competence-building assists stakeholders in seeing the larger picture and moving away from short-term financial goals (Matos & Silvestre, 2013; Ordonez-Ponce et al., 2021). Internal capacity building, including the provision of guiding resources, courses, and informal training, is especially important for internal stakeholders, as their response to stakeholder views during the process of redefining the business's value proposition relies on their ability to balance the interests of the stakeholders with those of the business and to ensure that their values and beliefs do not bias the value offered (Schneider & Clauss, 2020).

3.4.6 | Define/redefine the business purpose

The larger picture of SBM lies in defining or redefining the value proposition. Guo et al. (2022) showed that stakeholder interests and values can direct the business's value proposition or sustainability strategy. Setting up a corporate sustainability strategy, including an intentional triple bottom line targeted value proposition, can provide synergies for collective stakeholder goals and afford the focal company a competitive advantage in addition to an enhanced reputation (Morioka et al., 2017). A company's value proposition should be meaningful and valuable to its stakeholders and reflect its sustainability mission and overall purpose for existence. In line with this view, Acciarini et al. (2022) state that harmonising different stakeholder groups' interests when formulating a value proposition is the basis for a 'lasting value proposition' (p. 343).

The essence of the value proposition of the business hoping to adopt an SBM should exist in the realm of creating shared value. Studies have suggested that businesses that embrace and incorporate stakeholder interests and adopt sustainability aspects into their business value proposition have the potential to have improved brand image, customer loyalty and overall competitive advantage (Basile et al., 2021; Mihailova et al., 2022; Morioka et al., 2017; Pedersen et al., 2023).

3.4.7 | Adjust/adopt SBM

Once the business purpose has been decided upon and the value proposition that matches it has been drawn, the new BM can be adopted or adjusted accordingly. This part of the integration process entails practically deploying the value proposition that aligns with stakeholder needs and provides solutions to ecological value creation, social impact and economic growth. The adoption stage is described by Velter et al. (2020) as the instrumental level and alludes to the necessary alterations in business operations, which can be in the form of innovative pricing strategies, production and distribution methods and product or service designs. It is, however, worth noting that profit in SBM is a means to an end (keeping the business afloat to achieve social and environmental value) and not an end in itself (Guo et al., 2022; Stubbs, 2017; Upward & Jones, 2016).

Adopting the SBM will require continuous communication with stakeholders to foster and strengthen the relationship. This can also be advantageous for the focal business as it can be aware of any changes in stakeholder interests (e.g., effects of climate change on ecology) and adjust the BM as required. This can also afford the focal business an opportunity to identify new stakeholder groups as dynamics in ecological and social stakeholder groups evolve (e.g., interest networks, i.e., B Lab) (Stubbs, 2017).

3.5 | Stakeholder integration in the mining industry

In an effort to test the relevance of the SIM, the stakeholder engagement processes of 24 mining companies committed to sustainability in their business operations were assessed for alignment with the SIM.

3.5.1 | Stakeholders in mining business models

The analysis of the mining companies' corporate reports yielded some themes in terms of their BMs. The themes were spread across social, environmental and economic aspects, which make up the pillars of a SBM. In the social dimension, the companies express that engagement

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and relationship building are paramount for delivering social value, minimising social risk and facilitating sustainable mining practices. Collaborative partnerships and skills development initiatives between the stakeholders and focal business were also highlighted as a driver to expand the capabilities required for successful SBM implementation. Rio Tinto's annual report (2022) states, 'We partner with a growing network of stakeholders – governments, communities, customers, and suppliers – to expand our understanding, capabilities, and, ultimately, our ability to develop and operate new projects' (p. 17). To innovate in their business operations and create value for their stakeholders, these mining companies invest in creating and maintaining good relations with their stakeholders.

Secondary stakeholders have also been highlighted as contributors to the environmental dimension of these companies' BMs. Stakeholders such as governments have been seen as enablers of environmental value through authorisations and favourable regulations. For instance, the Australian government has approved a grant for Alcoa to initiate their carbon-emission reduction technology project. This positions stakeholders as contributors to resource efficiency, climate change mitigation and adaptation.

Although finances are not the sole motivating factor in SBM, the business needs to be financially lucrative to continue creating value for its primary and secondary stakeholders. The financial profitability of the businesses seemingly lies in their ability to diversify and collaborate with other stakeholders. The Sumitomo Metal Mining integrated report (2022) demonstrated this by reporting, 'We invest in copper and gold mines, develop mines with our partners, supply ore to our smelting & refining business, and sell some of the ore to outside parties' (p. 28–29).

3.5.2 | Stakeholder engagement in mining

The initial analysis of mining companies' BM indicates that these models rely on varying degrees of interaction and collaboration with stakeholders to achieve their business objectives. Consequently, we will now briefly share the strategy employed by mining companies to engage stakeholders within their BM. Although the companies reported their stakeholder engagement process in different ways, four common themes were found to be associated with their SE process.

Identification of stakeholders and their interests through materiality analysis was conducted by the mining companies. This is to identify stakeholder expectations, any risks associated with stakeholder dissatisfaction and any opportunities for value creation. For example, in 2020, Orano conducted an initial materiality assessment that involved approximately 160 managers and 130 external stakeholders; their views and insights were considered for future strategies.

Communication and knowledge sharing were highlighted by the companies. Continuous and open communication in the form of community meetings and grievance platforms was considered to foster trust between stakeholders and form a foundation for mutual value creation. Boliden's annual and sustainability report (2022) also explained their stakeholder engagement process by saying, 'we strive to add value for everyone affected by our operations through close dialogue and exchange of knowledge' (p. 30). In terms of knowledge sharing, AngloGold Ashanti spent up to $8.94 million on skills training and development as of 2022 to build knowledge capacity for local communities, as well as the interaction of the business with stakeholders (p.61).

Stakeholder participation in decision-making enables value creation in SBM and the companies; for example, Sibanye Stillwater also emphasises the inclusion of stakeholders such as industry bodies and unions in the companies' decision-making process. Teck also reported that engagement with stakeholders occurs on different levels of disclosure (e.g., reporting), dialogue (meetings) and participation (e.g., decision-making on community projects). Orano demonstrated the inclusion of stakeholders' views in decision-making by stating their achievement of the closure of Cominak mine in Niger and the subsequent rehabilitation of the area as requested by stakeholders.

Feedback and continuous improvement of stakeholder engagement were also a common theme in the stakeholder engagement processes. Most companies emphasised their commitment to actively seeking feedback from stakeholders and working with this feedback to improve their business operations; this came in the form of, for example, surveys and grievance mechanisms. This assists businesses with understanding the evolving interests of their stakeholders and ensures that they are well-informed and thus better equipped to improve areas that require immediate attention. For example, Anglo Ashanti integrated report (2022) states, 'Grievance mechanisms, together with accompanying resolution procedures, enable communities to lodge complaints that can be resolved' (p. 51).

The findings of the study show that successful SBMs require efficient stakeholder management to balance social, economic and environmental aspects. Stakeholders have also been found to contribute to value creation in SBMs. The engagement strategies suggested by both academic literature and industry include elements such as communication, knowledge sharing and continuous improvement, and these have been consolidated to present the SIM. Considering these findings, the next section provides a discussion.

4 | DISCUSSION

This study aimed to provide practical guidance to aid in the process of stakeholder integration in SBMs. The reviewed articles provided insight on what constitutes SBMs, shed light on the relevance of stakeholders in SBMs and suggested steps that businesses can take to integrate a wide range of stakeholders in their SBM. According to the literature, SBMs are BMs that balance economic, social and environmental factors in business activities with the goal of creating value for a wide range of stakeholders. This section discusses the relevance of stakeholders in these BMs and the elements that should be present in the stakeholder integration process, as suggested by academic literature and industry literature alike. These elements have been put together in the SIM to facilitate the integration process.

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Firstly, this study finds that the relevance of the stakeholders lies in their position as performance enhancers, enablers or inhibitors of value creation in SBMs. The analysed literature has shown that a wide range of stakeholders may improve an organisation's orientation toward sustainability and thus encourage innovations targeted at this (Cillo et al., 2019). Although businesses may engage in sustainability because of push factors such as regulatory requirements (Fiorentino et al., 2020) or pull factors such as market demand (Dijkstra et al., 2020), this only highlights the role of secondary stakeholders (e.g., the government) in influencing the longevity of the business. Therefore, both industry and academic literature point to the identification of stakeholders and their interests to create the right kind of value for the stakeholders as the prerequisite to strong sustainability action. Institutions that adopt strong sustainability strategies aimed at value creation for a wider range of stakeholders show increased performance (Giovanelli et al., 2021); thus, we can then view wide SI in SBMs as a performance enhancer.

Stakeholder integration in SBM is particularly important for businesses as a risk management exercise. Biloslavo et al. (2020) state that SBMs cannot be sustained without integrating secondary stakeholders, particularly in the context of factors related to social legitimation, which have a significant impact on a business's reputation. Legitimacy has been established as a critical resource for business growth and sustainability. Stakeholders, both primary and secondary, grant legitimacy to businesses in the form of social licences, and to this end, they can be seen as having the power to inhibit the successful existence of businesses. Denied social acceptance of a business can be costly (Poelzer & Yu, 2021), and repairing trust between the business and its stakeholders can be a long process (Matos & Silvestre, 2013). Nonetheless, for businesses to manage this potential risk, stakeholders should be integrated into the BM and their interests factored into decision-making. Integration challenges may be present (Velter et al., 2020), and strategic choices concerning the quality of integration (Breuer et al., 2018), how wide the range of stakeholders will be (Juntunen et al., 2019) and when during the BM innovation these stakeholders will be included, will have to be considered (Baldassarre et al., 2017).

Beyond being the granters of SLO, stakeholders have also been shown to contribute to SBM through resources, expertise, influence (Attanasio et al., 2022; Dentchev et al., 2018) and networks that may be crucial in implementing the SBM (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016). Thus, secondary stakeholders can be viewed as enablers of successful SBM implementation. To uncover this value-enabling capability of stakeholders, a joint purpose must be established between the business and the stakeholders; hence, the SIM and pertinent literature (Freudenreich et al., 2019) suggest creating a joint purpose and collaborating on it. The common theme of stakeholder participation in decision-making through consultation and knowledge-sharing initiatives, as highlighted by the mining companies, speaks to creating this joint purpose and sharing roles to achieve long-term success and maintain a competitive advantage.

Secondly, when exploring how businesses can successfully integrate stakeholders in SBM, we identify several elements commonly highlighted in both academic literature and industry discussions as crucial for integration. These elements are stakeholder identification, communication, knowledge sharing and continuous improvement. The process of stakeholder identification plays a pivotal role in assessing the extent to which value can be generated for the intended stakeholders (Freudenreich et al., 2019). To effectively generate value for a wide range of stakeholders, it is imperative to have a comprehensive understanding of their identities and their impact on the business. Failure to recognise these stakeholders may result in critical gaps in the organisation's strategic perspective (Freeman et al., 2007).

Literature encourages constant communication (Basile et al., 2021; Goni et al., 2021), negotiation (Pedersen et al., 2023) and trust-building through stakeholder integration (Andreassen et al., 2018; Sousa-Zomer & Cauchick-Miguel, 2017) to create a conducive environment to achieve enhanced performance. Hence, the SIM emphasises establishing and maintaining continuous communication. Consistent with this is the emphasis the sampled mining companies place on communicating frequently and openly with their stakeholders. Companies such as Vale have reported no employee strikes since 1989 as a benefit of consistently communicating with their stakeholders. Communication is a trust- and relationship-building exercise that facilitates stakeholder understanding and alignment of interests.

Knowledge sharing should be the cornerstone of achieving the joint purpose. The challenges associated with wide stakeholder integration, such as lack of education and cultural nuances, can inhibit the successful communication and collaboration required (Matos & Silvestre, 2013). Thus, the business has the responsibility to educate stakeholders about the business processes, the value creation opportunities and the potential benefits created by the existence of the business. Whereas the external stakeholders, such as local communities, should educate the business about customs and business practices and local trust-building processes. To ensure continuous improvement in the SBM and maintain SLO, businesses should maintain proper feedback mechanisms to be informed of the changes in stakeholder interests. This ensures the ongoing delivery of relevant value to stakeholders. (Baldassarre et al., 2017).

The stakeholder integration process is not linear and requires constant iteration as the interests of stakeholders change and the dynamic of SD evolves (Grijalvo & García-Wang, 2023). Mining businesses and other industries that aim to create broad value ought to continuously improve their processes of value creation, their communication with external stakeholders and their methods of stakeholder integration to ensure that they maintain their SLOs and uncover new value-creation opportunities. The SIM has been tested for its relevance in the mining industry. The SIM aligns with the industry's processes on stakeholder engagement and finds overlapping themes in the processes followed, such as the identification of stakeholders, communication, skills development and the redefinition of the BM viewed as continuous improvement by industry. This suggests that the mining industry is on the right track, or rather that these mining companies that have committed to sustainable business practices can serve as exemplars for companies hoping to integrate

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stakeholders into their BM and create value for a broad range of stakeholders.

5 | CONCLUSION AND IMPLICATIONS

In conclusion, SD is a solution for current global socio-economic and environmental problems. It relies on cooperation from various parties, including businesses. Businesses can contribute to SD by incorporating sustainable practices into their operations and making them a core part of their BM. Achieving this necessitates a shift to SBMs. SBMs balance economic, social and environmental factors in business activities, striving to create lasting value for a wide range of stakeholders.

Literature on stakeholder engagement in SBM has focused on different aspects, such as the role of the stakeholders in value creation (Fobbe & Hilletofth, 2021) and product development (Juntunen et al., 2019). Other studies have demonstrated the contribution of the stakeholders to company performance (Giovanelli et al., 2021). This study complements pertinent literature by consolidating the different aspects of stakeholder engagement and providing an adaptable process for businesses hoping to integrate stakeholders into their BM, as this could be an ambiguous and challenging endeavour with the dispersed information (Chirumalla et al., 2022; Evans et al., 2017).

Academic literature and mining companies highlight aspects that are necessary for successful stakeholder integration in business, hoping to innovate their BMs toward sustainability and create broad value. These aspects include stakeholder identification, communication, knowledge sharing and continuous improvement. Thus, this study presents an adaptable SIM that is anchored in these aspects. Implementing the SIM may be beneficial for businesses aiming to create shared value for all stakeholders involved, enhance stakeholder trust and legitimacy and secure an SLO.

The model can guide scholars on the aspects of the integration process that should be studied in different contexts; for example, scholars can investigate the process of bargaining during the establishment of a joint purpose and assess whether certain stakeholders' views get more preference from business managers or sustainability managers. Another interesting direction of future study could be the assessment of the applicability of SIM in other industries or in mining companies that are not part of the ICMM. Finally, scholars can investigate the incorporation of stakeholder interests into everyday business operations using integrated or sustainability management systems. This involves monitoring and measuring various aspects, such as stakeholder needs and expectations, as a key component of their research (Ranängen & Lindman, 2020).

The purpose of this study has been to provide practical guidance to aid in the process of stakeholder integration in SBMs based on insights gathered from existing literature. Based on the findings, stakeholders can be enablers or inhibitors of value creation through providing or withholding an SLO (Biloslavo et al., 2020; Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016); they can also be financial and non-financial performance enhancers (Guo et al., 2022). Thus, businesses can manage risk and uncover new value opportunities by identifying and including stakeholders in their BMs by following the steps in the SIM. Different steps of the model, such as the identification of stakeholders, can be guided by Freeman et al.'s (2007) stakeholder map and address each stakeholder's role using Fobbe and Hilletofth's (2021b) framework for the role of stakeholder intersection in SBMs. Furthermore, the value creation process suggested in the SIM can be fully understood by looking into Freudenreich et al.'s (2019) stakeholder value creation framework.

The SIM can be adapted to different businesses based on their size, resources and stage, and can be used as a guide to overcome the ambiguous process of stakeholder integration in SBM. For example, the SIM could be beneficial in the case of the energy distribution company in Brazil, which attempted to implement a SBM where waste recycling would be used to discount monthly electrical bills (Bittencourt Marconatto et al., 2016). However, due to improper stakeholder identification and stakeholder integration processes, the model was not successfully implemented. The SIM is crucial for businesses to ensure that they are considering the perspectives and interests of all stakeholders in their decision-making processes. The opinions and concerns of stakeholders can significantly impact a business's operations and success. Therefore, it is essential to incorporate their views into the business processes. This understanding can help in building stronger relationships with stakeholders, leading to improved decision-making and increased stakeholder satisfaction. Implementing SIM is crucial for businesses to create shared value for all stakeholders involved. This will help in achieving success in the long run, stakeholder trust, legitimacy and an overall SLO.

This study came with limitations; due to the manual method used to skim and scan during the initial article selection, other relevant articles may have been excluded due to misleading titles. Furthermore, the narrow perspective of stakeholder integration taken might have resulted in missed connections with other business processes that might have enriched the direction of this study. Nonetheless, future studies can address this by including an increased number of databases and conducting a robust article quality assessment (e.g., journal quality lists, citations). Future studies can also code for conflict resolution and extract data on strategies used to manage conflict with stakeholders in SBM.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST STATEMENT

All authors declare that they have no conflict of interest.

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APPENDIX A

Main literature sample analysis on year, typology, methodology and context, code, SBM, stakeholder theory and value themes.

Author (year)	Title	Typology	Methodology	Context	SBM	Stakeholders in SBM	SE strategies in SBM
Acciarini et al (2021)	Can digitalization favour the emergence of innovative and sustainable business models? A qualitative exploration in the automotive sector	Empirical	Case study	Automotive industry	Y	Y	Y
Andreassen et al. (2018)	Business model innovation and value-creation: The triadic	Conceptual		Product and services businesses, for example, Air BnB and Amazon	Y	Y	
Attanasio, Giovanna et al. (2021)	Stakeholder engagement in business models for sustainability: The stakeholder value flow model for sustainable development	Empirical	Case study	Wholesale, retail and transport industry	Y	Y	Y
Baldassarre et al. (2017)	Bridging sustainable business model innovation and user-driven innovation: A process for sustainable value proposition design	Mixed methods	Empirical (research through design)	Energy conservation project (climate change action)	Y	Y	Y
Basile et al. (2021)	The usefulness of sustainable business models: Analysis from oil and gas industry	Empirical	Case study	Oil and gas	Y	Y	Y
Biloslavo et al. (2020)	Business model transformation toward sustainability: The impact of legitimation	Empirical	Case study	Raw materials (yarn)	Y	Y	
Bocken et al. (2014)	A literature and practice review to develop sustainable business model archetypes	Conceptual		Business strategy	Y	Y	
Bocken et al. (2019)	Sustainable business model experimentation by understanding ecologies of business models	Empirical	Case study	Product-service business strategy	Y	Y	
Breuer et al. (2018)	Sustainability oriented business model development principles, criteria and tools	Theoretical	Literature review	Business strategy	Y	Y	Y
Chirumalla et al. (2022)	Mapping a circular business opportunity in electric vehicle battery value chain: A multi-stakeholder framework to create a win–win–win situation	Literature review		Electrical vehicle battery value chain	Y	Y	Y

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Author (year)	Title	Typology	Methodology	Context	SBM	Stakeholders in SBM	SE strategies in SBM
Cillo et al. (2019)	Understanding sustainable innovation. A systematic literature review	Literature review			Y	Y	
Comin et al. (2020)	Sustainable business models: A literature review	Literature review		Business strategy	Y	Y	
Dentchev et al. (2018)	Embracing the variety of sustainable business models: A prolific field of research and a future research agenda	Literature review			Y	Y	
Dijsktra et al. (2020)	Business model and sustainable plastic management: A systematic literature review	Literature review			Y	Y	
Evans et al. (2017)	Business model innovation for sustainability toward a unified perspective for creation for sustainable business models	Theoretical		Business strategy	Y	Y	Y
Fiore et al. (2020)	Stakeholders involvement in establishing sustainable business models the case of polish dairy cooperatives	Mixed methods	Case study	Dairy industry	Y	Y	Y
Fiorentino et al. (2020)	How smart technologies can support sustainable business models: Insights from an air navigation service provider	Empirical	Case study	Air navigation	Y	Y	
Fobbe and Hilletofth (2021a)	The role of stakeholder interaction in sustainable business models. A systematic literature review.	Literature review			Y	Y	Y
Freudenreich et al. (2019)	A stakeholder theory perspective on business models: Value creation for sustainability	Theoretical			Y	Y	Y
Goni et al. (2021)	Sustainable business model a review and framework development	Conceptual			Y	Y	Y
Giovanelli et al. (2021)	Business models for integration of sustainability in universities: An explorative analysis of Italian state universities	Empirical	Case study	Higher education	Y	Y	

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Author (year)	Title	Typology	Methodology	Context	SBM	Stakeholders in SBM	SE strategies in SBM
Guo et al. (2022)	Developing sustainable business model innovation through stakeholder management and dynamic capability. A longitudinal case study	Empirical	Case study	Sewage treatment	Y	Y	Y
Bittencourt Marconatto et al. (2016)	Developing sustainable business models within BOP contexts: Mobilising native capability to cope with government programmes	Mixed methods	Case study	Energy sector	Y	Y	Y
Matos and Silvestre (2013)	Managing stakeholder relations when developing sustainable business models: The case of the Brazilian energy sector	Empirical	Case study	Oil industry, electricity		Y	Y
Mihailova et al. (2022)	Exploring modes of sustainable value co-creation in renewable energy communities	Empirical	Case study	Energy	Y	Y	Y
Morioka et al. (2017)	Transforming sustainability challenges into competitive advantage multiple case studies kaleidoscope converging into SBM	Empirical	Case study		Y	Y	Y
Norris et al. (2021)	Linking sustainable business models and supply chains—Toward an integrated value creation framework	Empirical	Case study	Sustainable supply chain management	Y	Y	Y
Ordonez-Ponce et al. (2021)	Collaborative sustainable business models: Understanding organisations partnering for community sustainability	Empirical	Mixed methods		Y	Y	Y
Pedersen et al. (2023)	Navigating value networks to co-create sustainable business models: An actionable staging approach	Empirical	Case study	Laundry, textile, hospitals	Y	Y	Y
Pedersen et al. (2021)	Toward collaborative cross-sector business models for sustainability	Literature review			Y	Y	
Press et al. (2020)	The role of linked legitimacy in sustainable business model development	Empirical	Case study	Energy sector	Y	Y	Y

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Author (year)	Title	Typology	Methodology	Context	SBM	Stakeholders in SBM	SE strategies in SBM
Preghenella and Battistella (2021)	Exploring business models for sustainability: A bibliographic investigation of the literature and future research directions	Literature review			Y	Y	
Reinhardt et al. (2020)	Sustainable business model archetypes for the electric vehicle battery second use industry toward a conceptual framework	Empirical	Case study		Y	Y	
Schneider and Clauss (2020)	Business models for sustainability choices and consequences	Empirical	Case study		Y	Y	
Sousa-Zomer and Cauchick-Miguel (2017)	Exploring business model innovation for sustainability: An investigation of two product-service systems	Empirical	Case study	Mobility and water	Y	Y	Y
Stubbs (2017)	Characterising B corps as a sustainable business model. An exploratory study of B corps in Australia	Empirical	Case study		Y	Y	Y
Stubbs and Cocklin (2008)	Conceptualising a sustainability business model	Empirical	Case study and theory and abductive		Y	Y	
Tapaninaho and Heikkinen (2022)	Value creation in circular economy business for sustainability: A stakeholder relationship perspective	Empirical	Case study		Y	Y	Y
Upward and Jones (2016)	An ontology for strongly sustainable business models defining an enterprise framework compatible with natural and social science	Conceptual			Y	Y	
Velter et al. (2020)	Sustainable business model innovation: The role of boundary work for multi-stakeholder alignment	Empirical	Case study	Mixed organisations. NPO and FP	Y	Y	Y
Witjes and Lozano (2016)	Toward a more circular economy: Proposing a framework linking sustainable public procurement and sustainable business models	Conceptual		Public procurement	Y	Y	Y

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